

Julian Asilis

☎ (305) 934 6867
✉ asilisjulian@gmail.com
🌐 jasilis.com
U.S. citizen

Education

- 08/2022 – **Ph.D. in Computer Science**, UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA, Los Angeles
12/2026 Supported by [NSF Graduate Research Fellowship](#), 2024–present
(Expected) *Research*: Statistical learning theory; deep learning theory; deep generative models.
Advisor: Vatsal Sharan
- 2016 – 2020 **A.B. in Mathematics with High Honors**, HARVARD UNIVERSITY, Cambridge, MA
Senior Thesis: [Probability Monads](#), under Michael Hopkins.

Research

Theory papers typically use alphabetical author ordering.

12. **Resa: Transparent Reasoning Models via SAEs**
Shangshang Wang, [Julian Asilis](#), Ömer Faruk Akgül, Enes Burak Bilgin, Ollie Liu, Deqing Fu, Willie Neiswanger.
In submission, 2025.
11. **Textual Steering Vectors Can Improve Visual Understanding in Multimodal Large Language Models**
Woody Gan, Deqing Fu, [Julian Asilis](#), Ollie Liu, Dani Yogatama, Vatsal Sharan, Robin Jia, Willie Neiswanger
In *Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2026.
10. **Tina: Tiny Reasoning Models via LoRA**
Shangshang Wang, [Julian Asilis](#), Ömer Faruk Akgül, Enes Burak Bilgin, Ollie Liu, Willie Neiswanger.
In *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2026.
9. **Semi-Random Graphs, Robust Asymmetry, and Reconstruction**
[Julian Asilis](#), Xi Chen, Dutch Hansen, Shang-Hua Teng.
In *Innovations in Theoretical Computer Science (ITCS)*, 2026.
8. **On Agnostic PAC Learning in the Small Error Regime**
[Julian Asilis](#), Mikael Møller Høgsgaard, Grigoris Velegkas.
In *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2025. **Spotlight paper**
7. **Local Regularizers Are Not Transductive Learners**
Sky Jafar, [Julian Asilis](#), Shaddin Dughmi.
In *Conference on Learning Theory (COLT)*, 2025.
6. **Understanding Aggregations of Proper Learners in Multiclass Classification**
[Julian Asilis](#), Mikael Møller Høgsgaard, Grigoris Velegkas.
In *Conference on Algorithmic Learning Theory (ALT)*, 2025.
5. **Proper Learnability and the Role of Unlabeled Data**
[Julian Asilis](#), Siddhartha Devic, Shaddin Dughmi, Vatsal Sharan, and Shang-Hua Teng.
In *Conference on Algorithmic Learning Theory (ALT)*, 2025.

4. **Transductive Sample Complexities Are Compact**
Julian Asilis, Siddartha Devic, Shaddin Dughmi, Vatsal Sharan, and Shang-Hua Teng.
In *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2024.
3. **Open Problem: Can Local Regularization Learn All Multiclass Problems?**
Julian Asilis, Siddartha Devic, Shaddin Dughmi, Vatsal Sharan, and Shang-Hua Teng.
In *Conference on Learning Theory (COLT)*, 2024. (Open problems track)
2. **Regularization and Optimal Multiclass Learning**
Julian Asilis, Siddartha Devic, Shaddin Dughmi, Vatsal Sharan, and Shang-Hua Teng.
In *Conference on Learning Theory (COLT)*, 2024.
1. **Computable PAC Learning of Continuous Features**
Nathanael Ackerman, Julian Asilis, Jieqi Di, Cameron Freer, and Jean-Baptiste Tristan.
In *Logic in Computer Science (LICS)*, 2022.

Experience

- Summer 2025 **Machine Learning Engineer Intern**, *PINTEREST*, Seattle, WA
- Accelerated training of large-scale ads ranking model by 32% while improving AUC.
 - Implemented data subsampling/reweighting methods, including local case-control (LCC) and reweighted SGD, to improve efficiency and reduce training costs.
 - Performed extensive offline evaluations and ablation studies, providing insights on batch size, learning rate, and other hyperparameters that guided model optimization.
- June 2021 – **Research Associate**, *BOSTON COLLEGE*, Chestnut Hill, MA
- June 2022
- Researched computable learning theory and topological measures of complexity for neural nets, leading to a publication at LICS and extended abstract at CCA.
 - Served as TA for 2 computer science courses, including writing 140 pages of notes, overseeing 7 TA's, and writing scripts for automated exam grading.
- July 2020 – **Quantitative Researcher**, *AQR CAPITAL MANAGEMENT*, Greenwich, CT
- May 2021
- Refined and expanded several factors used to trade dozens of assets in fixed income.
 - Performed statistical inference and time series modeling on large panel data.
 - Delivered multiple 60-minute research presentations to senior quants and partners.
 - Wrote production code in Python and SQL.
- Summer 2019 **Research Summer Analyst**, *AQR CAPITAL MANAGEMENT*, Greenwich, CT
- Completed 10-week research project studying macroeconomic signals for the fixed income group, including extensive signal testing in Python.

Community

- Summer 2023 **SHINE Mentor**, *USC Summer High School Intensive in Next Generation Engineering (SHINE)*, Los Angeles, CA
- 2019 – 2020 **Math Mentor**, *Harvard Gender Inclusivity in Mathematics (GIIM)*, Cambridge, MA
- 2018 – 2019 **Teaching Assistant**, *Cambridge Math Circle*, Cambridge, MA

Skills

Programming: Python

Languages: English, Spanish